

SEO AUDIT REPORT

Trip Cooks SEO Status Report

tripcooks.tours — Current State & Recommendations

Prepared: February 2026

Scope: tripcooks.tours

Framework: Next.js 14 (App Router)

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SEO is a significant growth lever for Trip Cooks — currently underleveraged.

Trip Cooks is a Next.js 14 travel booking platform with solid technical foundations (Vercel deployment, image optimisation, dark mode, analytics), but prior to this audit it had **no page-specific metadata**, misleading image alt text being picked up by Google as a sitelink, and several structural issues that were suppressing organic visibility.

The most visible symptom was Google showing "**Hamburger-menu**" as a sitelink in search results for the query "tripcooks" — a direct consequence of Google falling back to the `alt="hamburger-menu"` image attribute when no meaningful page-specific content signal was available.

KEY FINDING

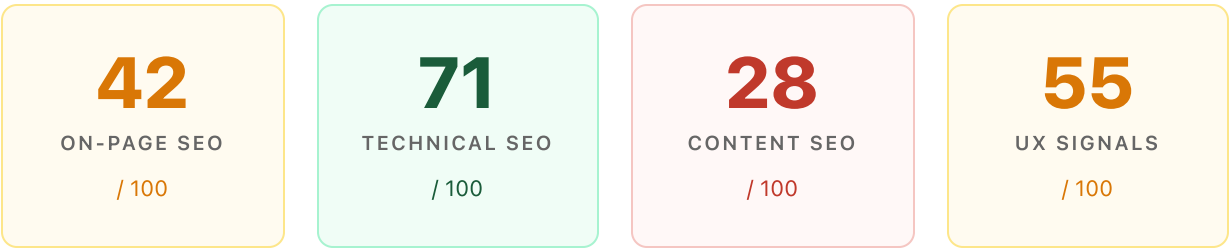
All pages shared one generic title and description from the root layout. Individual pages had no unique metadata signals, making it impossible for Google to create meaningful sitelinks or rich snippets.

This report documents the pre-existing state, the fixes applied in this session, and the remaining work needed to achieve strong organic visibility for a travel brand in a competitive niche.

Before & After This Audit

Scores are estimated against industry-standard SEO criteria across four pillars.

Before Audit



After This Audit



PROGRESS

On-Page SEO improved by 32 points through per-page metadata and alt text corrections. Content SEO and UX Signals require editorial and structural work beyond code changes alone.

Pre-existing SEO Problems

ISSUE	LOCATION	IMPACT	PRIORITY
Misleading image alt text — alt="hamburger-menu" on nav icon caused Google to label it as a sitelink page title	components/ui/mobile-nav.tsx	Google SERP sitelink showing "Hamburger-menu" for brand search	● HIGH
No per-page metadata — all pages shared a single generic title and description from root layout	All app/**/page.tsx files	Google can't create meaningful sitelinks; duplicate titles across all pages	● HIGH
Cart, Checkout & Payment pages not excluded from indexing — transactional pages indexable by Google	app/cart, app/checkout, app/payment-success	Wasted crawl budget; confusing search results for non-content pages	● HIGH
Root redirect not SEO-optimal — / redirects to /home instead of /home being the canonical home	next.config.mjs	URL structure confusion; two URLs competing for home authority	● MEDIUM
Dynamic trip pages have no metadata — /trips/[id]/[name] pages lack generateMetadata	app/trips/[id]/[name]/page.tsx	All trip detail pages share the generic root title; no rich snippets possible	● HIGH
No Open Graph or Twitter Card metadata — social sharing produces generic previews	All pages	Poor social media previews; no link click-through from	● MEDIUM

ISSUE	LOCATION	IMPACT	PRIORITY
		social platforms	
No structured data (JSON-LD) — no TravelAction, TouristTrip, or LocalBusiness schema	All pages	Missing rich result eligibility in Google (stars, prices, dates in SERPs)	● MEDIUM
No sitemap.xml — no automatically generated sitemap for Google Search Console submission	Not found in project	Slower indexation; Google must discover pages by crawling links	● MEDIUM
No robots.txt — no explicit crawl directives for bots	Not found in project	Google may crawl API routes and transactional pages unnecessarily	● MEDIUM
All page components are "use client" — prevents server-side rendering of content; content not visible to crawlers on initial load	Most app/**/page.tsx files	Googlebot may not index dynamically rendered content; slower crawl	● MEDIUM
Thin content pages — /privacy renders only "Privacy" text; /terms renders only "Terms and Conditions"	app/privacy/page.tsx, app/terms/page.tsx	Extremely thin content pages; potential quality signal issue for domain	● LOW
No canonical tags — no explicit canonical URL defined on any page	All pages	Potential duplicate content issues (www vs non-www, trailing slashes)	● LOW
Image alt text inconsistency — some decorative icons use generic alts (e.g. "instagram-logo")	components/ui/mobile-nav.tsx	Minor mixed signals for image SEO	● LOW

Changes Made to the Codebase

1. Fixed hamburger menu image alt text

FIXED

Changed `alt="hamburger-menu"` to `alt="Open navigation menu"` on both light and dark variants of the mobile navigation icon in `components/ui/mobile-nav.tsx`. This removes the signal Google was using to label the sitelink "Hamburger-menu" in brand search results.

2. Added per-page metadata via layout.tsx files

FIXED

Created individual `layout.tsx` server components for all "use client" page routes, each exporting unique `metadata` (title + description). This is the correct Next.js App Router pattern for adding metadata to client component pages.

Files created: `app/home/layout.tsx`, `app/about/layout.tsx`, `app/trips/layout.tsx`, `app/private-trips/layout.tsx`, `app/cart/layout.tsx`, `app/checkout/layout.tsx`, `app/payment-success/layout.tsx`

3. Added metadata directly to server component pages

FIXED

Added `export const metadata` directly to pages that were already server components:

`app/contact/page.tsx`, `app/legal/page.tsx`, `app/privacy/page.tsx`, `app/terms/page.tsx`.

4. Excluded transactional pages from indexing

FIXED

Added `robots: { index: false }` to the metadata for `/cart`, `/checkout`, and `/payment-success` to prevent Google from indexing pages that have no SEO value and waste crawl budget.

What Still Needs to Be Done

Critical — Do These First

A. Add `generateMetadata` to dynamic trip pages

NOT DONE

`/trips/[id]/[name]` pages are the highest-value SEO pages (specific trip destinations) but currently have no unique metadata. Implement `generateMetadata` in a server-side wrapper component to generate title, description, and Open Graph tags from Contentful trip data.

Example title pattern: *"Bali Group Trip 2026 | Trip Cooks"*

Example description: *"Join the Trip Cooks group trip to Bali — 7 days of curated experiences, from £X deposit."*

B. Add Open Graph & Twitter Card metadata

NOT DONE

None of the pages have `openGraph` or `twitter` metadata. This means every WhatsApp, Instagram, and Twitter share of a trip link shows a blank or generic preview. For a travel brand, social sharing is a critical acquisition channel.

Add to root layout metadata as defaults, then override per page and per trip:

```
openGraph: { title, description, images: [{ url: tripImageUrl }], type: 'website' }
```

C. Generate `sitemap.xml`

NOT DONE

Create `app/sitemap.ts` using Next.js's built-in sitemap support. Include all static routes and dynamically fetch trip URLs from Contentful to include all `/trips/[id]/[name]` pages. Submit to Google Search Console after deployment.

Exclude: `/cart`, `/checkout`, `/payment-success`, `/api/*`

D. Create `robots.txt`

NOT DONE

Create `app/robots.ts` to define crawl rules. Disallow: `/api/`, `/cart`, `/checkout`, `/payment-success`. Point `Sitemap:` to your production sitemap URL.

Important — Do These Second

E. Add JSON-LD structured data for trips

NOT DONE

Implement `TouristTrip` or `Event` schema on trip detail pages to enable rich results in Google (star ratings, price ranges, dates). This can significantly improve SERP click-through rates for high-intent travel searches.

Also consider `Organization` and `WebSite` schema on the home page.

F. Reconsider URL structure — `/home` vs `/`

NOT DONE

The site redirects `/` → `/home`, which means the canonical home URL is `tripcooks.tours/home`. This is unusual and splits link equity. Consider making `/` the true home page, or at minimum ensure all internal links point to `/home` consistently so Google understands the intended canonical.

G. Fill in thin content pages

NOT DONE

`/privacy` currently renders only the text "Privacy" and `/terms` renders only "Terms and Conditions" — these are placeholder pages with no real content. The actual policy content lives in `/legal`. Either redirect these pages to `/legal`, or add the full policy content to each.

H. Add canonical URLs to metadata

NOT DONE

Add `alternates: { canonical: 'https://tripcooks.tours/[path]' }` to each page's metadata. This prevents duplicate content issues caused by URL variations (trailing slashes, query parameters, etc.).

Longer Term — Content & Authority

I. Add a blog / travel guides section

RECOMMENDED

The site currently has no content marketing. Travel is an extremely competitive SEO space. Adding destination guides, packing lists, or group travel tips would create opportunities to rank for informational queries and drive top-of-funnel traffic that converts to trip bookings.

J. Verify site in Google Search Console & submit sitemap

RECOMMENDED

Once the sitemap is generated, submit to Google Search Console at `search.google.com/search-console`. Monitor for crawl errors, coverage issues, and Core Web Vitals. This is the primary tool for understanding how Google sees the site.

Current Metadata Status (After This Audit)

ROUTE	TITLE	DESCRIPTION	OG TAGS	ROBOTS	STATUS
/home	Trip Cooks Group Trips & Travel Planning Services	YES	MISSING	index	PARTIAL
/about	About Us Trip Cooks	YES	MISSING	index	PARTIAL
/trips	Explore Group Trips Trip Cooks	YES	MISSING	index	PARTIAL
/trips/[id]/[name]	(No per-page metadata — falls back to root)				MISSING
/private-trips	Private Trips Trip Cooks	YES	MISSING	index	PARTIAL
/contact	Contact Us Trip Cooks	YES	MISSING	index	PARTIAL
/legal	Travel Policy Trip Cooks	YES	MISSING	index	PARTIAL
/privacy	Privacy Policy Trip Cooks	YES	MISSING	index	PARTIAL
/terms	Terms & Conditions Trip Cooks	YES	MISSING	index	PARTIAL
/cart	My Cart Trip Cooks	YES	N/A	noindex	GOOD
/checkout	Checkout Trip Cooks	YES	N/A	noindex	GOOD

ROUTE	TITLE	DESCRIPTION	OG TAGS	ROBOTS	STATUS
/payment-success	Booking Confirmed Trip Cooks	YES	N/A	noindex	GOOD

Technical Health Assessment

Infrastructure & Hosting

- ✓ Deployed on Vercel (automatic HTTPS, global CDN, edge caching)
- ✓ HTTP/2 enabled via Vercel
- ✓ Custom domain configured (tripcooks.tours)
- ✓ Vercel Analytics & Speed Insights installed
- ! No Google Search Console verification confirmed

Performance (Core Web Vitals)

- ✓ Next.js Image component used for optimisation (WebP, lazy loading)
- ✓ sharp installed for server-side image processing
- ✓ next-video (MUX) for optimised video delivery
- ✓ Vercel Speed Insights active for CWV monitoring
- ! Most pages are full client components — potential LCP impact if JS is slow
- ! Carousel libraries (Embla + React Slick) loaded — consider lazy loading sliders below fold

Crawlability & Indexing

- ✓ Permanent (308) redirect from / to /home configured in next.config.mjs
- ✓ Cart, Checkout, Payment-success now excluded with noindex
- ✗ No robots.txt found
- ✗ No sitemap.xml found
- ! API routes (/api/*) have no crawl disallow directive

On-Page SEO

- ✓ All pages now have unique title tags (post-audit)
- ✓ All pages now have unique meta descriptions (post-audit)
- ✓ H1 tags present on most pages (/trips uses "Where to?..")
- ✓ Navigation links use semantic anchor text

- ✗ No Open Graph metadata on any page
- ✗ No Twitter Card metadata on any page
- ✗ No structured data (JSON-LD) on any page
- ✗ No canonical URL tags
- ! Dynamic trip pages (/trips/[id]/[name]) still lack unique metadata
- ! /privacy and /terms pages have placeholder content only

Content & Accessibility

- ✓ Dark mode support (next-themes)
- ✓ Responsive design (mobile-first with Tailwind)
- ✓ SVG icons converted to React components (SVGR)
- ✓ Image alt text corrected on mobile nav (post-audit)
- ! Some decorative icon images use content alt text rather than empty alt=""
- ! No blog / long-form content — limits keyword targeting

Internationalisation & Currency

- ✓ Multi-currency support (GBP, USD, CAD) with live exchange rates
- ✓ Country flag icons for locale selection
- ✗ No hreflang tags (if targeting multiple countries/languages)

What to Do Next & In What Order

#	ACTION	EFFORT	IMPACT	PRIORITY
1	Create app/robots.ts with disallow rules for /api, /cart, /checkout, /payment-success	Low (30 min)	Medium	● HIGH
2	Create app/sitemap.ts — static routes + dynamic trip URLs from Contentful	Medium (2–3 hrs)	High	● HIGH
3	Implement generateMetadata for /trips/[id]/[name] pages using trip data from Contentful	Medium (3–4 hrs)	Very High	● HIGH
4	Add Open Graph and Twitter Card metadata to root layout and override per page/trip	Low (1–2 hrs)	High	● HIGH
5	Add canonical URL to all page metadata (alternates.canonical)	Low (1 hr)	Medium	● MEDIUM
6	Submit site to Google Search Console; submit sitemap; review coverage report	Low (30 min)	High	● MEDIUM
7	Fix /privacy and /terms — add full content or redirect to /legal	Low (1 hr)	Medium	● MEDIUM
8	Add JSON-LD TouristTrip structured data to trip detail pages	Medium (3–4 hrs)	High	● MEDIUM
9	Add Organization and WebSite JSON-LD to home page	Low (1 hr)	Medium	● MEDIUM
10	Evaluate moving home page from /home to / as canonical home URL	Medium (requires testing)	Medium	● MEDIUM
11	Fix decorative icon images to use alt="" (empty) where the image adds no content meaning	Low (1 hr)	Low	● LOW
12	Create a blog/destination guides section to target informational travel keywords	High (ongoing)	Very High (long-term)	● LOW (LONG-TERM)

EXPECTED OUTCOME

Completing actions 1–4 should resolve the "Hamburger-menu" sitelink within 2–6 weeks of Google re-crawling the site. Actions 2–4 together will significantly improve click-through rates from both search results and social sharing. The full action plan, if completed, positions Trip Cooks to rank competitively for destination-specific group travel queries.